

Philipp Hilbert. *Payments PM who has shipped regulated, multi-stakeholder software from concept to production.*

Positioning, ten years of B2B SaaS product delivery, including payment flows, regulated platforms, and lean cross-functional teams — brought to bear on CardFlight's merchant growth agenda.

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§ WHY CARDFLIGHT

CardFlight sits at an interesting inflection point: profitable recurring revenue through a deep reseller channel, now accelerating direct-to-merchant and value-added services. That combination — channel partner constraints layered over direct merchant needs, with engineering resources that have to stretch across both — is exactly the kind of prioritization problem that rewards a PM who can hold the full picture and still write a clear PRD. The job description names "partner constraints" explicitly as something this PM must translate into engineering execution, which matches precisely how I have operated across every regulated, multi-stakeholder environment I have shipped in. *That is the kind of structural complexity where careful problem framing before solutioning makes the difference between wasted sprints and compounding momentum.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

My direct experience is with European payment infrastructure (PSP integration, P2P rails, group payment UX) rather than US acquiring, card network rules, or ISO channel dynamics specifically. The transferable mechanic is strong: I have worked in regulated, multi-party B2B SaaS environments where the channel partner's constraints and the end-customer's pain points

had to be reconciled into a single coherent roadmap – which is structurally identical to the CardFlight problem.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting, edge-case generation, spec review
 - **GPT**, discovery synthesis and problem statement structuring
 - **GitHub Copilot**, in-sprint implementation support
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, lightweight code reading and PR review
 - **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping before spec is locked
 - **Framer**, design-heavy workflow mockups
 - **Gamma.app**, stakeholder communication and roadmap decks
 - **n8n**, lightweight automation and agentic workflow design
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Helm, OpenShift, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, REST APIs, Redpanda, MicroStrategy, AngularJS, Ionic, CGM API integration, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTEST ENGINE & DEV-AGENT FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Personal crypto trading infrastructure built from scratch to validate execution ideas and automate research.

- Implements a backtesting engine for crypto market strategies, including perpetual futures and spot execution models.
- Pairs with a custom multi-agent orchestration framework built on file-queue-based agent loops and n8n automation.
- Covers exchange connectivity to Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, and 1inch, with real order routing and slippage analysis.

- Demonstrates end-to-end product ownership of a data-intensive system – discovery, architecture, iteration – directly relevant to CardFlight's analytics and data-informed decision-making expectations.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT CARDFLIGHT

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Join every standup, reseller call, and support review I can access; map the current merchant pain points against what Pendo data and support tickets show, and surface any disconnects between what partners report and what usage metrics confirm.

WEEK 2

Synthesize, then sharpen.

Draft a problem-statement map from week one's inputs, review it with the team for blind spots, and identify the one roadmap item where requirements ambiguity is creating the most engineering friction.

WEEK 3+

Write, ship, close.

Own a first PRD through refinement and sprint planning, coordinate the launch-readiness checklist across marketing, operations, and the partnership team, and release with documentation and partner communications aligned.

I COVER LETTER

CardFlight's model – distributing through hundreds of ISOs and acquirers while simultaneously accelerating direct merchant acquisition – creates a product management problem I find genuinely compelling. The reseller channel imposes hard constraints on what you can ship and when. The merchant end is where the value is actually experienced. Holding both in the same roadmap, without letting one crowd out the other, requires exactly the kind of structured prioritization and clear cross-functional communication this role describes.

My most directly relevant experience is at Emil Group, where I managed an InsurTech B2B SaaS platform serving primary insurers, reinsurers, MGAs, brokers, and underwriters simultaneously

– every release had to thread the same needle of channel partner readiness and end-customer value. I rebuilt sprint discipline on a 17-person team that had lost delivery stability, split it into focused Scrum units with ownership structures, and restored client trust through weekly product workshops and honest communication about technical complexity. That environment taught me that the most important PM skill in a multi-stakeholder channel business is writing a problem statement everyone agrees on before anyone writes a line of code.

At Rohde and Schwarz, working on a government-contracted AI data platform with multinational stakeholders, I owned feature delivery end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout. I reduced deployment times from several days to under forty minutes by introducing ArgoCD, and I unblocked an infrastructure issue in OpenShift that had been open for over a year – delivered in one week by working directly in the codebase alongside engineers. The technical fluency was not incidental; it was what let me write requirements engineering teams could actually build from without constant clarification loops.

On the payments side, I co-founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a group-based P2P payment product built on a P2P backbone with full PSP integration, UX design, and a mobile prototype – later acquired by Sparkasse. I understand how payment flows break, where edge cases live, and why the onboarding experience for merchants matters as much as the transaction logic underneath it. My experience does not include US acquiring or ISO channel mechanics specifically, and I want to name that directly. The structural problem – reconciling channel partner constraints with end-merchant needs inside a revenue-weighted roadmap – is one I have navigated repeatedly, and I would expect to close the domain gap quickly through the discovery calls and reseller conversations the role describes.

I work in a lean, autonomous style and have consistently operated as the person who clarifies the path when requirements are incomplete. I use AI tooling daily – not as a substitute for judgment but as a way to synthesize discovery inputs faster, generate edge cases before engineering asks for them, and move from problem statement to spec without unnecessary delay. That is the cadence CardFlight's four-person team needs. I would be glad to discuss how my background maps to the specifics of SwipeSimple's roadmap and the current acquirer channel.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience shipping B2B SaaS in regulated, multi-stakeholder environments. Background spans AI data platforms, analytics infrastructure, InsurTech, mobile healthcare, and payment products. Operates effectively in lean teams with incomplete requirements and shifting priorities, translating messy operational realities into dev-ready specifications. Technical fluency across modern software systems allows direct collaboration with engineering without intermediary layers. Founder-level pragmatism, low ego, high delivery discipline.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Problem-first discovery: structured problem statements before solutioning begins
 - Multi-stakeholder roadmap prioritization across channel and end-customer needs
 - Cross-functional alignment across engineering, marketing, operations, and partners
 - Clear requirements engineering: user stories, acceptance criteria, and PRDs that build from
 - Launch readiness ownership: documentation, partner comms, and release coordination
 - Data-informed decision making with product analytics and usage metrics
 - Payment flow and PSP integration product experience
 - Sprint discipline, backlog management, and delivery stability in lean teams
 - AI-native product execution and rapid prototyping
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Led cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked infrastructure-level OpenShift issues independently; delivered in one week a feature that had been open for over a year

- Responsible for data transformation, transparency, and auditability with multinational stakeholders
- Enabled ML training and evaluation on curated datasets with transparent evaluation concepts (SafeAI, ExplainableAI)

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered new features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; standardised CI/CD with full test integration
- Designed interactive dashboards, community features, and admin tooling against a public analytics audience
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout on a multi-party B2B channel platform
- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability; split a bloated 17-person team into focused Scrum units with ownership and deputy structures
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and document storage on iOS and Android
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows under tight legacy API constraints
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity across external database dependencies

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone, including full PSP integration, UX design, and mobile prototype
- Designed end-to-end payment flows and edge-case handling across consumer onboarding, group settlement, and transaction processing
- Product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner

- Owned product architecture for backup, restore, checkpoint, and quantum-secure data encryption based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
- USP: full setup in under two minutes, no technical knowledge required; served as deputy IT security officer

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO, CFO, Head of HR

- Established full digital tooling, financial and investment planning, and ERP introduction across the company lifecycle

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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